mocking what they viewed as a trifling issue for the protestors to focus on—and yet, Mohandas knew that if any issue could be embraced by every caste and economic hierarchy of India, it was that of overpriced salt. Every household required salt, and India was perfectly capable of producing its own, affordable stock of the mineral.

It had been over a decade since the violent massacre at Amritsar, and Gandhi believed that he and his fellow protestors were ready to make a big scene with zero violence. He was right. As Nehru, Gandhi, and other members of the Indian National Congress made their way to Dandi, the crowds swelled into the tens of thousands by the time the journey reached its end on April 5th. At the edge of India, where seawater met the land, Gandhi walked into the water to make salt. He found that the natural salt crystals from the surf had already been crushed and pounded into the sand by teams of police, but that didn't dissuade him from his purpose. He reached into the wet sand and found a large, uncrushed piece of salt, plucking it from the sea and thereby defying the salt law. Thousands joined him, both in Dandi and other coastal regions, collecting and harvesting their own salt from the sea. Great numbers of those practicing willful civil disobedience were women, proud and at last enabled to speak up for themselves and their nation.

The British government was not amused. Mohandas Gandhi was arrested and put in jail, but his followers were so inspired by the salt march that they went ahead with a protest at the Dharasana Salt Works on May 21st. The police were ready for the disobedience, and when about 2,500 peaceful activists arrived on the scene, the former struck out with clubs. It was another massacre, this time at the hands of native Indians against their own people at the command of the British. Worse, not one of the protestors raised a hand in violence or even self-defense, perfectly executing their ideal of peaceful protest. The police beat down at least 300 people and killed two.

The *United Press* described a brave and commanding woman at the head of the protest pack:

> Prayers said as white-clad volunteers knelt in the moonlight and an impassioned speech by the poetess-leader, Mrs. Sarojini Naidu, opened the mass attack of 2,500 independence demonstrators today on the Dharasana Salt Works. The poetess, wearing a rough, homespun robe and soft slippers, but